

GMDC
Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation Ltd.

BEYOND MINERALS, BUILDING FUTURES

From the wind-scoured salt flats of Lakhpat in Kutch—India's last village along the Kori Creek—to the forest-clad hilltops of Chhotaudepur, and eastwards to the temple towns of Odisha, the Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation (GMDC) is quietly rewriting what it means to be a responsible corporate citizen.

Through its social development arm, the Gramya Vikas Trust (GVT)—founded in 1991, long before 'CSR' became corporate jargon—GMDC has woven together a model of progress that is both systemic and deeply human. In 2024–25 alone, touching over 12 lakh lives across 290 villages. Its priorities are clear: healthcare, education, and skills—delivered with scale, precision, and a keen sensitivity to local realities.

A Doctor at Your Doorstep

In hamlets where a hospital can be a day's journey away, GMDC-GVT's healthcare comes not in marble-floored buildings, but on wheels. The Jan Chikitsa Seva (JCS) Programme, launched in 2023 with Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Limited (AHEL), operates ten Mobile Medical Units across Gujarat and Odisha.

These are no mere symbolic gestures. Each unit follows a meticulously planned route, offering on-site GP consultations, over 85 essential medicines free of charge, zero-cost pathology, and real-time teleconsultations in 15 specialities. Emergencies—cardiac arrests, strokes, seizures, accidents—are met with round-the-clock support.

In just over a year, more than 95,000 consultations have reached a catchment population of 13 lakh. Women form 58% of the beneficiaries, and each visit costs an average of ₹1,243—removing the financial barriers that once kept treatment out of reach.

Anchoring this mobile care are GMDC's hospitals at Akrimora Thermal Power Station (Lakhpat) and Kadipani (Chhotaudepur). With emergency, dental, and gynecological facilities, diagnostics, and pharmacies, Kadipani treats 70 patients daily, ATPS 50—lifelines where previously there was none.





Education: The First Step Forward

In tribal at Kadipani location Chhotaudepur, where English-medium schooling can feel like an impossible leap, GMDC-GVT supports GMDC Atul Vidyalaya with zero debt deficit, ensuring tuition along with mid-day meal are free for every child. The school's high standards offer rural and tribal students the kind of education once reserved for the cities.

Lakhpat tells a harder story. Literacy here is just 51.2%, with women at 42%—a gap GMDC is determined to close. Partnering with the DAV College Trust, it has established an inclusive school within its colony, giving pastoral families a rare gateway to quality education.

Beyond these flagship efforts, the Trust's reach is broad: 26,700 students in Gujarat and Odisha have received free notebooks in 2024–25. In Kutch, a dedicated bus service now carries 250+ children from far-flung villages to school—many of them the first in their families to cross a classroom threshold.

Skills: From Training to Transformation

Education lights the mind; skills secure the future. Recognising this, GMDC launched the Samarthya Employment Oriented Skill Training Programme in 2023, running six residential centres across Gujarat and Odisha. Here, young men and women train in 12 industry-relevant trades—from solar installation to hospitality—while also learning soft skills and workplace discipline.

The results are striking: 2,130 youth trained, with an 86% placement rate. Over 90% report greater self-reliance, and 67% note improved financial stability. In Odisha's Chhendipada block, 37 young people have already graduated in partnership with Dr. Reddy's Foundation; 22 have secured jobs, bringing new income into households once reliant solely on subsistence work.

Conclusion: The GMDC-GVT Model

What makes the GMDC-GVT approach so effective is its interdependence. Good health enables consistent schooling. Education strengthens the impact of skill training. Skills bring income, which sustains both learning and wellbeing.

An independent review calls it a "sustainable and scalable model of community development"—a blueprint for how public sector CSR can be inclusive, measurable, and deeply rooted in local needs.

In India's most remote corners, where opportunity rarely arrives, GMDC has ensured that progress not only comes—it stays. And in doing so, it has proved that the greatest resource any miner can unearth is human potential itself.

